

Potential Acquisition

The land owner would like to see the property preserved as open space but requires financial compensation for the land. This parcel abuts and complements the 77 acre Lockwood parcel. These two parcels together, if protected, would make an outstanding open space on their own. However, because of their proximity to the Boxford State Forest, these parcels would add considerably to the aesthetic, wildlife and recreational value of the state forest lands. Several habitats found on these properties are missing or occur in very small quantities within the state forest.

Preservation of this parcel would protect: valuable wildlife habitat; protect the integrity of the regional trail system; protect the water quality of Fish Brook and the Ipswich River; and greatly add to the diversity of wildlife habitat associated with the Boxford State Forest. In addition, the protection of the Lockwood parcel would be compromised if this parcel was not protected as well thus, protection efforts should include both parcels. The proximity of this parcel to the Boxford State Forest and the Phillips Wildlife Sanctuary make these parcels together a logical addition to the Boxford State Forest lands.